

Stock Photography Reference Guide

BIG SISTER FOUNDATION

Curated royalty-free images from Unsplash for the BSF landing page.
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01 — Hero & Banner Images

Primary above-the-fold images. These set the emotional tone. Use the strongest one as the main hero, and rotate others for A/B testing or seasonal campaigns.

01 Smiling boy — warm, joyful child portrait

Photo by Felipe Ditadi

Hero banner (above the fold)

Warm, candid joy. Perfect for the primary hero image.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/sminking-boy-folding-clothes-uesqf4qBODo>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/uesqf4qBODo/download?force=true>

02 Girl in green academic dress

Photo by Muhammad-Taha Ibrahim

Hero banner (alternate)

Achievement & aspiration. Green dress echoes brand color.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/girl-in-green-academic-dress-4BvH27qTJ58>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/4BvH27qTJ58/download?force=true>

03 Group of young children together

Photo by Ayano Tosin

Hero banner or "Our Impact" section

Community, togetherness. Multiple children = collective impact.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-group-of-young-children-standing-next-to-each-other-oSg7-6B10zo>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/oSg7-6B10zo/download?force=true>

04 Girl smiling close-up

Photo by Atharva Tulsi

Hero or testimonial section

Intimate, personal connection. Great for "Meet a beneficiary" spotlights.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/girl-smiling-close-up-photography-qw7-LHj4jS8>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/qw7-LHj4jS8/download?force=true>

02 — Three Pathways

Images mapped to BSF's three pathways: children from difficult backgrounds, children with special needs, and gifted/talented children. Each should feel hopeful, never pitying.

01 Person reading on the ground

Photo by Kimberly Farmer

Pathway 1: Difficult Backgrounds

Resilience through education. Reading as escape and empowerment.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-person-sitting-on-the-ground-reading-a-book-hjZlhj8ej7U>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/hjZlhj8ej7U/download?force=true>

02 Smiling girl in wheelchair

Photo by Nathan Anderson

Pathway 2: Special Needs

Joy and capability. Wheelchair is present but the smile is the focus.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-smiling-girl-in-a-wheelchair-looks-at-camera-3KE9QgHzH9M>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/3KE9QgHzH9M/download?force=true>

03 Young graduate making heart with hands

Photo by Gift Habeshaw

Pathway 3: Gifted & Talented

Achievement + heart. Love for learning. Graduation symbolizes potential realized.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-young-graduate-makes-a-heart-shape-with-her-hands-bFMmD2yufEI>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/bFMmD2yufEI/download?force=true>

04 Smiling student giving peace sign

Photo by Gift Habeshaw

Pathway 3 alternate or general education

Confidence, happiness in school. Authentic student energy.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-smiling-student-gives-the-peace-sign-x6Qwl1GxbNg>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/x6Qwl1GxbNg/download?force=true>

05 Children focused on lessons in classroom

Photo by Gift Habeshaw

Education section or Pathway 1

Active learning environment. Shows investment in education infrastructure.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/children-focus-on-their-lessons-inside-the-classroom-2JFGBQhdHu0>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/2JFGBQhdHu0/download?force=true>

06

Student drawing with ruler

Photo by Gift Habeshaw

Pathway 3 or "How It Works"

Precision, skill development. Hands-on learning moment.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-student-carefully-draws-lines-with-a-ruler-zzcHmwBaG0w>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/zzcHmwBaG0w/download?force=true>

03 — Mentorship & Empowerment

The "Big Sister" relationship in visual form. Women supporting each other, learning together, building community. These go in the About, Mentorship, or How It Works sections.

01 Two women talking outdoors

Photo by Christina @ wocintechchat.com

Mentorship / "Big Sister" section

Core brand concept — mentorship in action. Warm, natural setting.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/two-women-talking-while-sitting-outdoors-DkHva1p24Bk>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/DkHva1p24Bk/download?force=true>

02 Women seated together on couch

Photo by Christina @ wocintechchat.com

About Us or Team section

Professional, approachable. Clean background works well with brand palette.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-couple-of-women-sitting-on-top-of-a-white-couch-5tteWzfhMaA>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/5tteWzfhMaA/download?force=true>

03 Two women outdoors with palm trees

Photo by Hian Oliveira

About or Mentorship section

Tropical setting resonates with Lagos. Two women = sisterhood.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/two-women-standing-outdoors-with-palm-trees-b77PBkwAo8I>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/b77PBkwAo8I/download?force=true>

04 Three women reading a book together

Photo by Alexis Brown

Community or "How It Works"

Group learning / shared knowledge. Aligns with BSF's community model.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/three-women-sitting-on-a-couch-reading-a-book-Dos4d3uls1U>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/Dos4d3uls1U/download?force=true>

04 — Community & Roots

Tree gatherings (the iroko metaphor), Lagos cityscapes, graduation moments. These ground the foundation in place and purpose. Perfect for backgrounds, footers, and storytelling sections.

01 People gathered under a tree

Photo by Deb Dowd

Background or "Our Story"

THE iroko tree metaphor come to life. Community sheltering under a tree.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/people-are-gathered-under-a-unique-tree-hTPw7Pqbzbg>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/hTPw7Pqbzbg/download?force=true>

02 Group standing around a tree

Photo by Shane Rounce

"Our Story" or Footer background

Gathering, roots, community. Directly maps to brand metaphor.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-group-of-people-standing-around-a-tree-J3YZR8CHaCw>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/J3YZR8CHaCw/download?force=true>

03 Group standing under a tree

Photo by Shane Rounce

Alternate community image

Shade, protection, togetherness. Natural canopy = sheltering presence.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-group-of-people-standing-under-a-tree-bQiFYSwkJ3w>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/bQiFYSwkJ3w/download?force=true>

04 Woman in graduation cap and gown

Photo by Gift Habeshaw

"Impact" or success stories

The end goal — graduation. Aspirational, tangible result of support.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-woman-in-a-graduation-cap-and-gown-w8bE2Jm6Rlo>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/w8bE2Jm6Rlo/download?force=true>

05 Lagos aerial photography

Photo by Ninthgrid

Background texture or footer

Lagos cityscape. Grounds the foundation in its geography.

View: <https://unsplash.com/photos/aerial-photography-of-city-6UqJTfoXlq8>

Download: <https://unsplash.com/photos/6UqJTfoXlq8/download?force=true>

05 — Quick Download Checklist

Open each "Download" link in your browser to save the full-resolution image. Organize into folders matching the sections above.

Recommended folder structure:

Stock/

Hero/ — 4 images

Pathways/ — 6 images

Mentorship/ — 4 images

Community/ — 5 images

Total: 19 curated images

Image Optimization Notes

For the live site (per the Vision doc targets):

- Convert all images to WebP format (40-60% smaller than JPEG)
- Hero images: max 1920px wide, quality 80
- Card/section images: max 800px wide, quality 75
- Use srcset for responsive loading (480w, 800w, 1200w, 1920w)
- Lazy-load everything below the fold
- Target: total page weight under 800KB on first load
- Consider blur-up placeholders (tiny 20px base64 → full image)

Photographer Credits (for footer or credits page)

While Unsplash doesn't require attribution, crediting photographers is good practice and aligns with BSF's values of transparency.

📍 Felipe Ditadi

📍 Muhammad-Taha Ibrahim

📍 Ayano Tosin

📍 Atharva Tulsi

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